# thames view



YOUR COMMUNITY MAGAZINE

ISSUE 5

JUNE 05

# LIBERTY X



## POPULAR BEATS COMING TO YOUR STREETS

Liberty X • Alexander O' Neal • Javine • Phixx

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

# Tavy Bridge Timeline

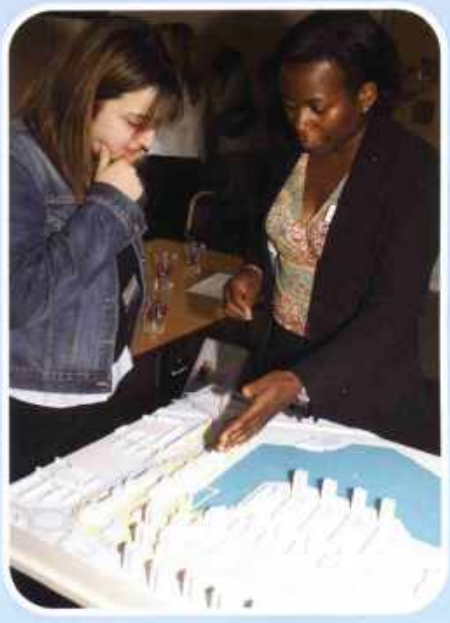
Tavy Bridge has often been on the receiving end of negative press. Over the last few years in particular it has been portrayed as an area where crime and anti-social behaviour is rife. While residents recognise that there are problems, they also realise that people's perception of Tavy Bridge is far removed from the reality. While the regeneration of Tavy Bridge will go a long way in overturning these gloomy ideas, the transformation of Thamesmead extends beyond the estate's borders. New housing is springing up all around the area attracting many young professionals and key workers.

This in turn will see an increase in demand for retail outlets and shops and restaurants. As the transport infrastructure develops so too will the potential for businesses and organisations to establish themselves within easy reach of the City. All these factors are coming together making Thamesmead a powerful platform for long-term success. Finally, the press is beginning to notice that times are a-changing in Thamesmead.

A recent feature in the Evening Standard highlighted the many positive changes that are taking place. Stylish new housing and improved transport links are helping put Thamesmead back on the map for all the right reasons. Opinions may be changing but it seems some people still need to be convinced. *"The biggest challenge is getting people down here,"* says Stephen Garton of Fairclough Homes. *"Thamesmead has an image problem but it is much better than it was. Their perceptions are five years out of date."*

As more and more families and young people set up home in Thamesmead, we are determined that existing residents also enjoy the social and economic rewards of the area's growth. That's why we are bringing Trust Thamesmead's Building Futures programme to Tavy Bridge.

Launched some 2 years ago, Building Futures is a training and employment initiative offering practical advice and support for all those seeking work. Starting from 21st June, a weekly drop in session will be held between 10am and 4pm at 12 Tavy Bridge. The Building Futures programme enjoys enormous success and it is an ideal opportunity for anyone needing help in finding employment and seeking training. For more information please call Trust Thamesmead on 020 8 320 4470.



ISSUE #5

# editorial

## Fun in the Thamesmead sun

Summer is always a busy time in Thamesmead and over the next few months it is set to get busier. As the weather warms up the lakes and parks are filling up with people enjoying the many activities on offer. Chartlon Athletic are providing football coaching for the young people, Southmere Boating Centre is running weekend sailing courses and gardeners everywhere are planting, hoeing and growing. But don't worry, there's plenty for those who prefer to be a little less active in their leisure time.

The Graffiti Project to be held over the summer holidays is a great way for young people to show off their artisitic side. And for those who like to watch what's going on from the sidelines, don't miss the Arts Summer Festival to be held on Bexleyheath Broadway on 11th June where the London Chinese Culture and Art Community Organisation will be performing their spectacular lion dance. It's all happening out there so don't miss out.


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# OUT AND ABOUT



Some of the green team taking a break with Jody Specht

## Branching out

Eleven teenagers from the Bexley Business Academy in Thamesmead have discovered an unlikely new passion – gardening. When asked how the Year 11 students wanted to fill a spare two hours every week the group decided to get involved in community work. All agreed that the elderly residents of Sanderling Court should have an attractive garden to enjoy. Their plans for a new look garden however go far beyond simply planting and weeding. The youngsters have built bird tables and plant pots and have even designed and produced mosaic tiles to be laid in a corner of the garden. Jody Specht, BBA's offsite and adventure activities co-ordinator, invited Gallions Housing Association to have a look at how their garden was being transformed. Jody believes that the project has sparked an interest in the young people. *"At the beginning it was difficult to keep the group focussed but now they are all really enjoying it and can see how their hard work is beginning to pay off."*

While the group was initially surprised at how hard the work was, they were really shocked at the amount of rubbish that was thrown over hedge. Jody says that all of the children are now firmly against dropping litter. For many in the group it is the first time they have been fully involved in such a project - their enthusiasm and commitment is a success story in itself.

## We're going to the zoo

**After balloon races, cake bakes and a series of fund raising activities, the children of Waterways nursery in Thamesmead finally got enough funds together for a trip to Howletts Zoo. Accompanied by staff from Gallions Housing Association, an assorted group of carers, mums and dads set off to visit the animals. Poor weather did not dampen the children's enthusiasm as they gathered around the gorillas and cooed over the clouded leopard. The trip was organised by Waterways' Nathalie Nunn. *"We made the fund raising activities as much fun as possible and it was great to see all the children fascinated by the animals."***



**Waterways Nursery is currently looking for people to join their Management Committee. Their role will be to input into the day to day running of the nursery. Please contact Shirley Golbourne on 0208 311 5491 for further details.**

# IN THAMESMEAD

## Making the right choice

When Tina Zendel's disability benefit went missing in the post again, she knew it was time to think about setting up an account where all her benefits could be paid direct. Tina suffers from MS and is wheelchair bound. To track down her missing payment she had to take a taxi to the job centre in Woolwich where she had to wait four hours before somebody was able to sort it out. Tina turned to Lesley Edwards at Gallions for help. Lesley is a member of a project set up specifically to help people understand the changes in benefit payments that are taking place and the choices available to them. Tina says:

*"When I received Lesley's letter telling me to contact her for advice on setting up an account I didn't hesitate. Lesley came to see me and went through all the different options. We decided that I should open a post office account. It's a big relief that I no longer have to worry about missing giros and all the problems of sorting that out."*

**The whole process took just three weeks and Tina now spends more time painting her beautiful paintings than worrying about missing cheques.**





## Get afloat this summer

The summer is finally here and what better way to enjoy the sunshine than messing about in boats? At Southmere Boating Centre in Thamesmead there's something for every keen sailor, whether your first time on the waves or an experienced sailor. On Saturdays adults can enjoy RYA sailing and BCU kayaking courses while schools and youth groups can visit throughout the week to take advantage of the centre's excellent facilities and equipment. On Tuesday and Thursday evenings through the term time and all day on weekdays during the school holidays, young people can turn up, join in and learn how to sail, canoe and kayak.

For more information on times and fees call the centre on 020 8310 2452, send an email to southmere@boating.fsbusiness.co.uk or visit the centre's website at **www.southmereboating.co.uk**

**Change, a partnership of ten housing associations, launched the Benefits and Banking project to help residents understand what alternatives are available. If you would like individual help in setting up a bank or post office account please contact Lesley Edwards on 0208 320 3495.**

# Team Gallions **Update**

**The summer months are always a particularly busy time for Team Gallions. Whether they are polishing floors or delivering free bedding plants to the elderly, they are always striving to keep your neighbourhood as clean and attractive as possible. With members of Team Gallions now being trained at gold level BICSc, residents can continue to enjoy the rewards of a committed and professional environmental services team. Irene George tells us what the team is up to.**



It is now our floor-polishing season where we tackle landings, stairs, and lift lobbies. In total we buff up some 270 floors. Residents will receive a letter telling them when we will be polishing the floors in their block and advising them to avoid walking over the wet polish. The problem with wet polish is that if someone walks on it Team Gallions has to go over it again and hope it dries before another person does the same. The alternative is a set of footprints enshrined for the next twelve months till we do it all again.



Anyone with a vehicle knows how difficult it is to park in and around Thamesmead – planners did not imagine the levels of car-ownership in the 21st century. However, at Team Gallions we want to ensure that the parking spaces available are used legitimately. Currently we are looking at ways to try and stop the practice of parking caravans in car parking spaces. Under current tenancy agreements for rented properties caravans cannot be parked without permission. Our problem is identifying the caravan owner and asking them to shift their vehicle – one solution may be to just start carting away caravans parked on our land. Watch this space.

**As Thamesmead gears up for the Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival in July, Team Gallions has been asked to come up with an appropriate contribution to the bandstand area. We have put on our creative thinking hats and have come up with what we think is an 'amaizing' approach to landscape gardening. (We're hoping people will be lost in admiration!) All of the team will be giving it their all to ensure that everyone enjoys a bright, colourful and safe day out. Our role also includes creating an exciting setting for the under-5's bouncy play area and ensuring that the whole festival area is clean and tidy before the big day kicks off. After all, no one wants to step in something nasty on a fun day out**

Last autumn we launched a successful community project where we provided an array of free bedding plants for our elderly residents. Many residents already brighten communal balconies and walkways with their own plants and visitors often comment that the blocks where elderly residents live always have really good floral displays. For instance, when you come out of the lift on a number of floors in Buckwheat Court you are met with a spectacular sight of flowers in bloom. So last autumn we decided to help where we could, and residents were so pleased that we decided to do the same again this spring.





**This is usually the time of year when keen gardeners get down to the serious business of growing tomatoes. Many novice horticulturalists however may not yet be confident enough to tackle this particular challenge. Team Gallions, always happy to help gardening enthusiasts of every level, are giving away free growbags to anyone who wants to grow their own tomatoes. Whether you are an experienced tomato grower or just starting out why not give us a call on the freephone number, leave your name and number and we will sort you out with a growbag.**

## 'Cool' Team Gallions

has discovered an interesting local phenomenon – the public fridge. That is, the unwanted fridge supplied on every street corner by person or persons unknown and actually not so cool. The figures, if not the fridges, give food for thought. Each month we find about 120 lonely and abandoned fridges, and they are very costly to dispose of. Luckily we have identified an excellent contractor who will, for a price, collect them for recycling. The last load to go consisted of 178 fridges, with 54 immediately arriving from their own street corners to take their place in the yard. So many fridges! Anyway, whatever the reasons behind this bizarre state of events, for information on the correct disposal of fridges free of charge phone the **freephone number 0800 83 84 81**. Just don't stick 'em on the street, please.



**Thames 21 specialises in clearing up London's rivers and canals and works in partnership with Team Gallions. Rubbish in our canals is a big problem in Thamesmead and Thames 21 is looking for volunteers to help keep them clean. You don't have to get wet (although some might like to). If you would like to help please contact us on 0800 838481**



## GRAFFITI PROJECT

**It's set to be a really colourful summer this year when the Gallions and Axis graffiti campaign kicks into action. We're hoping that the best of Thamesmead's young talent will come along and show us their painting skills. We're supplying the wall under the Archway at Binsey Walk, the spray cans and some local community artists to help. If you are interested in showing off your skills or even just providing the paint, please contact Wendy Mason on 0208 320 3417.**

one to one



# Giles Randall

**This summer's Trust Thamesmead Festival in Birchmere Park is set to be one of the biggest and brightest entertainment events Thamesmead has ever seen. And it's about time says Festival Director Giles Randall. Here he tells Joy McKee why the residents of Thamesmead deserve a 'Party in the Park' to be proud of.**

For Giles Randall July's festival goes far beyond chart-topping acts and first-class family entertainment. It's about putting something together that not only draws in the local community but acts as a springboard for Thamesmead itself. He says, *"Too many people outside of Thamesmead have such a negative perception of the area. The Festival is an opportunity to demonstrate how Thamesmead is an accepting, embracing and developing community."*

His determination to change these perceptions has shaped every aspect of the festival planning. The calibre of the promotion together with the high-profile acts is already attracting significant press interest and Giles is sure that the Festival will receive good media coverage. *"The support from local businesses and Greenwich Council has been fantastic"* Giles says. *"It is clear that they have confidence in us and trust us to get the job done properly".*

## Powerful Potential

Every aspect of Giles' 20-year career could have been carefully selected to propel him to his role today. A graduate of Doreen Bird's Dance, Drama and Stage Production School, a former police officer and a trained ballet dancer there are many, many strings to Giles' bow! From parking and crowd control to creative input, Giles' wide-ranging experience brings a depth of understanding, and enthusiasm, that is second to none. The last big occasion in Thamesmead was the Jubilee Festival in the summer of 2002 and Giles is keen to deliver an even better event to an even bigger audience. Giles' commitment to Thamesmead is clear for all to see. He believes it has enormous potential and is keen to use the Festival to maximise that potential.

## Community Focus

With plenty of parks and open spaces available Giles believes Thamesmead residents deserve an event of this scale on their doorstep. *"There are a number of summer festivals nearby but this one is for and about the Thamesmead community."*

250 children from eight Thamesmead schools are currently involved in festival workshops whilst drama groups, dance troupes and sports clubs are preparing to play their part on the community stage at an event where the spotlight will be focused firmly on Thamesmead. Giles knows that the celebrities' management companies are impressed by the scale and organisation of the Festival. He is also very aware that this event is without a doubt the most ambitious that Thamesmead has hosted. But that ambition is being translated into a real 'buzz' as all those involved are gearing up for a really big day. Giles says,

*"Thamesmead itself is full of ambition but you must demonstrate that ambition if you are to convince others that you are going places. This Festival is a showcase for all that Thamesmead can offer."*

Simply getting all the pieces into the right places is like building a small city says Giles. *"It will take four days to get the infrastructure up and running with electricity, water, first aid areas and toilets all to be provided and three stages to be built. It will take another three days to dismantle the whole affair and return the park to normal."*

**While the set can be built and dismantled in seven days, most people believe that the Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival of 2005 will be remembered for a lot longer than that.**



# Audio x - all you need to create stunning music

The Audio x Music Course is a LOCN accredited using Reason music software (which is a virtual studio). It includes all the major things you would find in a large recording studio but all within one easy to use programme. You will learn how to make and edit beats and use synthesisers and samplers to create your own music, which can then be burnt onto CD. **The next 12 week course will be starting at the end of the summer. Please call the Thamesmead Youth Awareness Project on 0208 311 5111**

# STARS IN THEIR EYES

## YOUR CHANCE TO MEET LIBERTY X



**Chart-topping band Liberty X are headlining at this year's Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival and you could be backstage meeting them. If you are 16 years of age or under and you are living at home with a Gallions resident then why not enter our competition? The lucky winner, their parent or guardian and two of their friends will spend some time with the band on the day. It is a great opportunity to meet up with one of the UK's best-known chart acts. All you have to do is tell us in no more than 20 words why you would like to meet the band.**

Please complete the form below and return it to us no later than Monday 20th June 2005.

Name: Age:

Address:

Parent/Guardian's name:

Telephone number:

I would like to meet Liberty X because -

Send your entry to Joy McKee at Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH or email jmckee@gallionsha.co.uk with your entry and personal details. We will contact the winner week beginning 27th June 2005.

• the winner must be aged 16 or under and must be accompanied by an adult • the winner may nominate two guests (maximum of 4 people in winning group) • the prize in non-transferable

# Dates for your diary

We want to build clear channels of communication between Gallions and our residents. Why not come along and see what's happening in your neighbourhood.

## Tel: Wendy Mason 0208 320 3417

### Neighbourhood Forums

Have your say on community issues and how services are delivered in your area

**9th June** Southmere 7.00pm Tavy Bridge Hall

**13th June** Moorings 7.00pm Arnott Club

**19th July** Crossway and Manorway 6.30pm Manor Close Hall

**27th July** Lesnes, Parkview and Greenmead 7.00 pm Atrium

### Resident Information Sessions

Help and advice about banking issues
Understanding your Rent Statement

**9th June** Moorings 1.30pm – 3.30pm Jubilee Hall

**15th June** Parkview 10am – 12pm Teeswater Atrium

**23rd June** 1.00pm – 3.00pm – Community Resource Centre

### Street Briefings

Talk to your local police about local issues

**7th July** at 7pm Hartslock Drive outside Trewsbury House

**19th August** at 7pm, Fairway Drive outside football cage

**28th September** at 7pm Limestone Walk outside the shop

# News Review

## Maintaining Standards

A lot of work is going on with our maintenance investment programme. Working with Axis Europe we will be painting the outside and internal common areas of properties. We will also be re-roofing, replacing windows and modernising homes with new kitchens and bathrooms as well as re-wiring. The work is being phased in over the next ten months and will affect the following properties.

| | |
|---|---|
| Re-roofing: | Argali, Dexter, Masham, Jacob, Clydesdale, and Trefoil House |
| Decorations: | Argali, Dexter, Masham, Jacob, Clydesdale, Trefoil, Harlequin, Hibernia and Radley House |
| Modernisation Works: | Jacob, Clydesdale, Trefoil, Harlequin, Hibernia and Radley House |
| Window Replacement: | Disraeli Close Houses, Macauley Way Flats, Owen Close Houses, Owen Close Flats, Leaonard Robins Path Flats & Houses, Rowntree Path Houses, Nassau Path Houses, Mangold Way Houses, Hinksey Path Houses |

## Coming soon to a corner near you

Street Briefings (formally known as Roll Calls) allows the residents of Thamesmead to come out and meet their police Safer Neighbourhoods teams. These Street Briefings provide an opportunity for the community to interact with local officers on their own street corner and discuss anything concerning them.

It also enables the public to hear officers being briefed by supervisors prior to their evening patrol – and residents can even contribute if they want to. A number of street briefings have been arranged for Thamesmead – just check the diary dates for your nearest briefing.

Why not come along and find out what it is all about?

# Are you covered?

Could you afford to replace all your belongings? How would you cope if a thief broke in or a fire swept through your home? Your furniture, decorations and other belongings are not automatically insured by your landlord against theft, fire, vandalism and flooding. So, if you haven't thought properly about contents insurance cover, you could be in for a shock. However, you are now able to arrange insurance for the contents of your home at a special low cost rate through a special scheme introduced by Gallions Housing Association - premiums start from a few pence per day.

The cover, which is arranged by specialist broker Jardine Lloyd Thompson Tenant Risks, has been designed to help tenants and leaseholders insure most of their belongings as easily as possible.

The minimum value of contents insurance available is £9,000, or £6,000 if you are aged over 60. The scheme will cover belongings on a "new for old" basis with no age limit and there is no excess on claims. The policy includes fire, theft, and water damage and provides substantial levels of cover on items from freezer contents to replacement locks. Take some time to think about the cost of replacing all the items in your home - it soon adds up!

**Tenants can find out more about the scheme by contacting the Customer Contact Team tel: 0800 838481 or by attending our open afternoon on Wednesday 29th June between 2pm and 4.30pm Each visitor will be entitled to enter a competition to win £25 of store vouchers**

## 12 Months Home Contents Insurance from only £3.07 per fortnight.

**No Quote Required**
Premiums Shown Below

*** For tenants aged over 60 premiums start from just £2.23 per fortnight**

### Pay As You Go Home Contents Insurance

(a special scheme for residents of Gallions Housing Association, in association with Jardine Lloyd Thompson Tenant Risks)

| Sum Insured | Fortnightly Cost | Monthly Cost | Annual Cost |
|---|---|---|---|
| *£6,000 | £2.23 | £3.64 | £43.68 |
| £9,000 | £3.07 | £5.46 | £65.52 |
| £10,000 | £3.35 | £6.07 | £72.80 |
| £12,000 | £3.91 | £7.28 | £87.36 |
| £15,000 | £4.75 | £9.10 | £109.20 |
| £20,000 | £6.15 | £12.13 | £145.60 |

*only available for applicants over the age of 60

Sums insured are available from £6,000 to £30,000; all premiums, terms and conditions are stated within a free information pack.

- Low cost insurance from only £65.52 (or £43.68 if you are aged over 60)
- Paid fortnightly at any post office, monthly by Direct Debit or annually by cheque/Postal Order – see premiums in the table opposite
- All post codes included at no additional cost
- No security requirements
- No long term commitment – you literally 'pay as you go'

**For more information please call:**

**0845 4082033**

In association with

JARDINE LLOYD THOMPSON Tenant Risks

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

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## LEASEHOLDERS LINE

Our weekly leaseholder sessions at the Tenants Resource Centre are your opportunity to come along and discuss any issues or concerns you may have as a homeowner. Please call Yinka Akinyemi or a member of the team on 0208 320 3424 to make an appointment. We no longer run our drop in sessions so do call and make appointment beforehand.



**GALLIONS FREEPHONE 0800 83 84 81**



# Mutual Exchange **Database**

Gallions Housing Association has launched an exciting new initiative aimed at those tenants who are currently on the transfer list awaiting new properties. Whether you are looking for a bigger house, a smaller flat or simply the chance to move nearer your family, the mutual exchange database will give you more choice in where you go. If you are interested in this scheme we will enter details of your current accommodation as well as details of what you are looking for. Using the information on the database we will then be able to identify potential 'swaps' between tenants. Everyone eligible has already been sent an application form so if you are interested simply fill in the form and return it to Gallions. If you would like more details about how this programme can help you find the right home, please get in touch with the **Customer Contact Centre on 0800 838481. Remember, the more people who sign up to join the database the greater the choice for everybody.**

## The Complete Drugs Course

is a 12 week course for young Greenwich residents to learn the facts and the fiction about everything related to drugs. The course is open to people aged between 16 and 24 and starts on 23rd June 2005. Looking at such issues as fund raising and book keeping it may help you find employment in that field. For more information please call the Thamesmead Youth Awareness Project on **0208 311 5111 or email office@tyap.in-volve.org.uk**

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phong bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

June 05

**PUNJABI** ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐

(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

## Contact us

**Gallions Housing Association**
**Harrow Manor Way**
**London**
**SE2 9XH**

For all enquiries please contact the
**Customer Response Centre**
**0800 83 84 81**
It's a freephone number that you can use to book services, repairs or for any other enquiries.

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION